गुरु घासीदास विश्वविद्यालय, बिलासपुर
केंद्रीय विश्वविद्यालय अधिनियम 2009 संख्या 25, 2009 द्वारा केंद्रीय विश्वविद्यालय
Guru Ghasidas Vishwavidyalaya, Bilaspur
A Central University established by the Central Universities Act 2009 No. 25 of 2009

Letter of Recommendation

To Whom It May Concern,

I am pleased to recommend Yash Varshney, who worked with our research team as a Research Assistant on the study titled *"Do Context Models Learn the Right Mechanism? A Controlled Evaluation of Inductive Biases for Context-Aware Tourist Recommendation."* The paper has been accepted for presentation and publication in the proceedings of the 2026 IEEE International Conference on Applied Intelligence Devices, Machine Learning, and Data Science (AIDML 2026), following a positive evaluation by the reviewers and the Technical Program Committee.

Yash made a substantial contribution to the technical development of the project. He took responsibility for the complete coding and experimentation pipeline, including data generation, model implementation, experiment execution, evaluation, visualization, and result organization. He contributed more than 30 meaningful commits to the project repository and played a central role in maintaining the codebase throughout the research process.

His responsibilities extended beyond writing individual scripts. Yash managed the full research repository, coordinated changes across different components, and ensured that the experimental workflow remained organized and usable. He helped maintain consistency across model configurations, random seeds, evaluation procedures, output files, and supporting documentation. His careful repository management made it easier for the team to trace results, identify issues, and reproduce the experiments reported in the manuscript.

Yash also took an important role in developing the project's reproducibility artifact. He helped structure the code and documentation so that the reported experiments could be rerun under clearly defined settings. This included organizing scripts, preserving experimental configurations, documenting dependencies and execution procedures, and ensuring that generated results corresponded with those presented in the paper. Reproducibility is an essential but frequently overlooked aspect of machine-learning research, and Yash approached this responsibility with diligence and maturity.

Importantly, Yash was not limited to implementation work. He actively interpreted the experimental results and contributed to the scientific reasoning behind the study. Our research compared several recommendation approaches, including collaborative filtering, logistic regression, XGBoost, factorization-based methods, neural models, and a monotonic environmental gating architecture. Yash examined the differences among these models and participated in discussions about why the strongest predictive model was not necessarily the model that most faithfully represented the intended contextual mechanism.

He demonstrated the ability to recognize that predictive accuracy and mechanism fidelity are distinct research objectives. When results were mixed or did not fully support an initial expectation, he did not simply report the numbers. He considered alternative explanations, suggested improved comparisons, and proposed better ways of evaluating and presenting the findings. His ability to engage with unexpected or negative results reflected a level of scientific maturity that is uncommon at his academic stage.

Yash also contributed useful suggestions for strengthening the study. He considered alternative modeling options, supported robustness and comparison experiments, and helped the team refine the interpretation of the results. His input was valuable in shaping the paper into a more balanced investigation of inductive bias, interpretability, and predictive performance rather than a simple claim of model superiority.

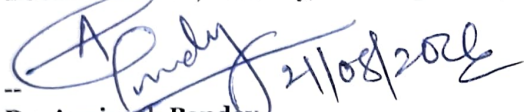
The acceptance of the paper at IEEE AIDML 2026 provides external recognition of the relevance and technical quality of the work. The reviewers described the manuscript as a timely contribution with sound methodology, appropriate experimental validation, and clear presentation. Yash's work on the implementation, repository management, reproducibility artifact, and result analysis contributed directly to the quality and completeness of the accepted study.

Throughout the project, Yash was dependable, professional, and responsive to feedback. He communicated progress clearly, addressed technical issues carefully, and revised code and documentation when improvements were needed. He showed initiative while also working effectively within a collaborative research team. Over the course of the project, he became increasingly capable of handling complex tasks independently.

What impressed me most was the breadth of his contribution. Yash participated across the full research lifecycle: implementation, debugging, experiment management, repository maintenance, reproducibility, result interpretation, methodological discussion, and manuscript support. These are responsibilities generally associated with university-level research assistants, and he handled them with persistence, intellectual curiosity, and a strong sense of responsibility.

Based on my experience working with him, I believe Yash has excellent potential for further study and research in computer science, artificial intelligence, machine learning, data science, and related fields. He possesses not only programming ability, but also the discipline required to maintain a complex technical project and the analytical judgment needed to question, interpret, and improve research outcomes.

I recommend Yash Varshney with confidence for academic programs, research opportunities, internships, scholarships, and other technically demanding positions. I am confident that he will bring the same initiative, reliability, and thoughtful approach to his future work.



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